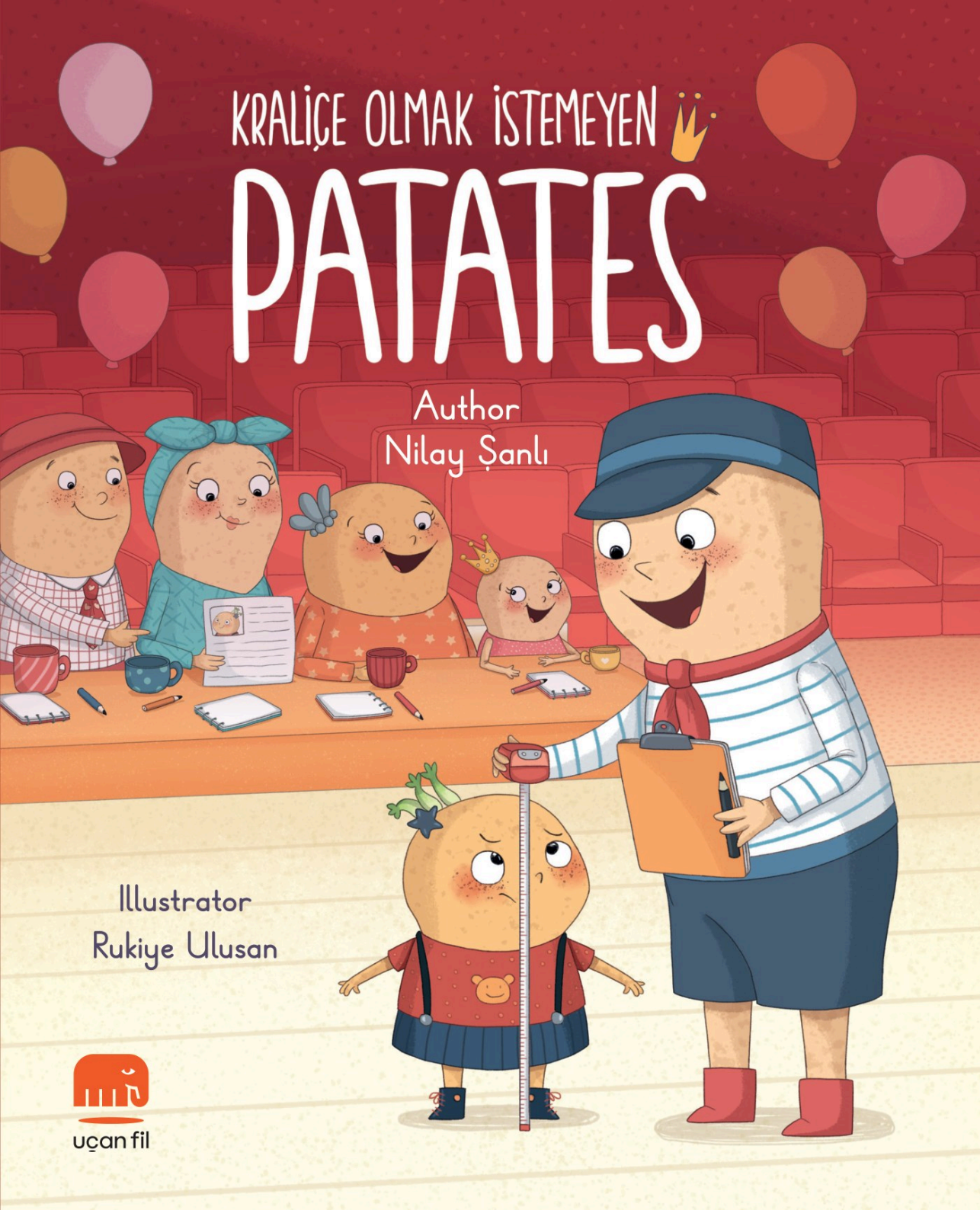
KRALİÇE OLMAK İSTEMEYEN PATATES

Author
Nilay Şanlı

Illustrator
Rukiye Ulusan



uçan fil

KRALİÇE OLMAK İSTEMEYEN PATATES



Kraliçe Olmak İstemeyen Patates
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All the potatoes in the village were in a flurry of excitement. The annual beauty pageant was being prepared with great care once again that year. Announcements had been made, a grand hall had been reserved, and the jury members had been selected.

Last year's beauty queen was among the jury members, too. All that was left now was to choose the contestants.





A long line had formed in front of the hall. The potatoes were waiting eagerly; except for one.

"Mum, I'm so bored. Let's go home already!" said Starch.

"No way, my child. We've only been waiting for four hours. Just another hour or two and we're in," her mother replied.

Starch pouted and went back to observing the other potatoes in line.



Potato mums and dads were adjusting their children's clothes and sprouts, stepping back to take a look, and fixing things all over again if they weren't satisfied. The little potatoes stood perfectly still so their outfits wouldn't get dirty or wrinkled.



Starch thought, "Everyone's so excited..." But to her, the whole contest felt pointless.
On top of that, the corset under her outfit was incredibly uncomfortable. It was squeezing her so tightly that it was hard to move, and it was starting to hurt a little.

"Mum, this corset is way too tight!"

"Hang in there, Starch. We're almost there."

"Do I have to hang in with my teeth too?"

"No, I mean just be patient a bit longer."

"Mum, I'm about to explode. Let's just go home. I don't even want to be in this contest."

"Oh, don't say that! You're such a beautiful potato. I'm sure you'll be crowned beauty queen this year."

Starch knew there was no convincing her mother. So her only wish was not to be chosen as a contes–tant.

And finally, it was their turn...



Starch waddled onto the stage. A huge banner hung on the back wall, reading: "41st Annual Beauty Contest."

"Oh, how important," Starch thought to herself. "Let's all say 'mashallah' 41 times." She stood in front of the banner, glaring at the judges.

From the audience, her mother was waving her arms and calling out, "Smile, Starch, smile!" while also making exaggerated smiling faces. Starch giggled when she saw how silly her mum looked.



